

UNO: Guardians of the Deep

A Fantasea Feature Film Treatment

Some machines are built to take from the ocean. One was built to give something back.

Logline

A curious dolphin is given a second chance by a kind scientist and a brave young woman. Together they inspire a movement that frees captive animals, heals the oceans, and teaches technology how to care.

Synopsis

Twenty years ago, two fisherman brothers, Marty and Elias, parted ways after Marty tried to sell a captured dolphin to poachers. Elias left the sea in guilt, studied robotics, and built a secret underwater lab dedicated to protecting the oceans. Marty built an Aquapark empire, publicly posing as an ocean guardian while secretly continuing to exploit marine life and corrupt officials.

In the present, Elias rescues a critically injured dolphin and creates the first hybrid prototype: 001, half biological, half machine. Marty discovers the technology, charms his brother into handing it over for ocean cleanup, and turns 001 into the commander of a robotic fleet. Secretly, Marty develops militarized killer narwhals and mosquito drones to sell to rogue forces.

When 001 — later named Uno by Sarah, Marty's idealistic daughter — begins to feel and choose for himself, she uncovers her father's true plans. Together with Elias, she upgrades Uno with a biological heart and an EMP capability. The former machine becomes the first true Guardian of the Deep, proving that technology guided by empathy, not profit, can heal the oceans and protect the future.

Act One — Two Brothers, One Choice

The Brothers

Twenty years ago, on a small fishing boat off the Australian coast, two brothers pull a young dolphin from their nets. Marty, the older and more ambitious of the two, sees only profit. He wants to sell the animal to poachers. Elias, younger and idealistic, is horrified. "We're not selling a living creature," he says. The argument ends their partnership. Elias walks away from the family business that day and never returns.

Marty continues. He sells exotic fish, cultivates relationships with corrupt officials, and eventually opens his first Aquapark. Publicly he is a showman and entrepreneur. Privately he expands a network of poaching and captivity, faking natural births of dolphins and orcas to justify new facilities and larger profits.

Elias's Redemption

Elias carries the guilt of those years. He studies robotics and bio-engineering, eventually building a secret high-tech laboratory beneath the ocean. His goal is singular: to create technology that protects the seas rather than exploits them. He begins designing robotic systems capable of removing plastic, monitoring reefs, and deterring illegal fishing. The project is called Guardians of the Deep.

Meanwhile, Marty's daughter Sarah grows up inside the Aquapark empire. As a child she presses her hand against the glass of a small tank and shares a quiet, wordless moment with a captive dolphin. The connection stays with her. As a young adult she studies bio-engineering at a prestigious university in Sydney, still working shifts at the park, still carrying the quiet sorrow of the animals she cannot free.

The Creation of 001

In the present day, a curious young dolphin triggers an underwater mine. Critically injured, he is rescued by Elias, who brings him to his underwater lab and performs a radical procedure fusing living tissue with advanced robotics. The result is the first hybrid: half biological, half machine, cyborg — prototype 001.

Act Two — The Fleet and the Lie

The Reunion

Marty reconnects with his long-lost brother and convinces him to hand over his project. Elias hesitates. He wants only to protect the oceans. Marty promises exactly that. Reluctantly, Elias agrees. 001 is transferred to Marty's control and becomes the commander of a growing robotic fleet launched from a massive solar-powered mothership.

The Double Game

Publicly, Marty presents the fleet as a triumph of green technology: robots that eat plastic and convert it into fuel. "We turn trash into treasure," he tells cameras. Privately, in a dark office with corrupt officials and a military commander, he unveils the real product line, classified: Guardians Military Edition. Killer narwhals. Swarm mosquito drones. Torpedo whales. "Cleanup was good PR," he says. "This is the real deal."

Uno Meets the World

While supervising the cleanup fleet, 001 drifts beyond his designated perimeter. He encounters a pod of wild dolphins playfully passing a pufferfish. One of them shoves the fish into his mouth. The toxins scramble his systems. Hallucinations and childhood flashbacks overwhelm him. HUD warnings flash: Low Battery. Oxygen Critical. He surfaces in a daze and collides with a young woman on a surfboard — Sarah.

Using the last of his power and oxygen, he saves Sarah's life. Both are washed ashore. Her university friends, Theo and Jasper, help carry the unconscious cyborg to the bio-engineering lab. There, she sees the serial number 001 and renames him Uno.

The Discovery

While Uno is resurrected, Sarah returns to the Aquapark for a routine shift. She overhears her father negotiating the military deal. Shaken, she returns to the lab. She discovers that Uno was created by Elias, and reaches out to him for help.

Act Three — The First True Guardian

The Upgrade

Elias arrives at the university lab. Together, he and Sarah perform a second transformation. She installs a living biological heart. Elias equips Uno with an EMP device capable of disabling the militarized robots, and uploads a new layer of data — music, poetry, philosophy, and history — an algorithm of empathy and meaning. For the first time, Uno can feel.

The Choice

Armed with emotion and purpose, Uno returns to the ocean. He confronts the fleet that once obeyed him and the weapons Marty is preparing to deploy. Using the EMP and the loyalty of the original cleanup robots, he disables the military variants without destroying the beneficial technology. The Guardians of the Deep are reclaimed for their original purpose.

Resolution

Marty is exposed. The Aquapark empire faces public reckoning. Elias and Sarah stand together with Uno as the robotic fleet resumes its true work: cleaning plastic, protecting reefs, and guarding the living ocean. Uno, once a serial number, now swims with a heart — and with a family that chose him.

And somewhere below, the ocean is choosing its guardian.